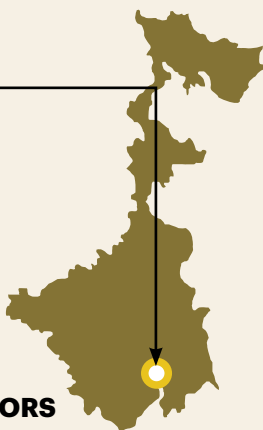


## Haldia

The city accounts for 3.6% of West Bengal's GDP. The big industries include petrochemicals, power, fisheries, and agriculture



### ECONOMIC INDICATORS

Gross Domestic Product (GDP):

**\$8** billion

Per Capita GDP:

**₹1.4** lakh

### DEMOGRAPHIC DYNAMICS

Population:

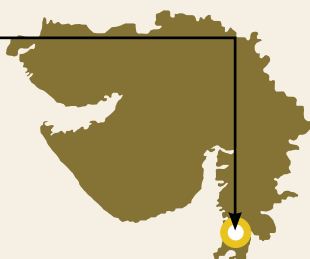
**284,000**

Literacy rate:

**88.5%**

## Vapi

The city accounts for 3.5% of Gujarat's GDP. The big industries include paper mills, chemical plants, kitchen appliances, pharmaceuticals, plastics, rubber, and textiles



### ECONOMIC INDICATORS

Gross Domestic Product (GDP):

**\$11** billion

Per Capita GDP:

**₹2.8** lakh

### DEMOGRAPHIC DYNAMICS

Population:

**300,000**

Literacy rate:

**89%**

**NOTE:** CONSIDERING AN AVERAGE GROWTH RATE OF 8% FOR GDP CALCULATION  
PER CAPITA GDP CONSIDERED FOR FY22

**SOURCE:** MUNICIPAL CORPORATIONS, ECONOMIC SURVEY, AND INDUSTRY ASSOCIATIONS

to five years," he says.

But it isn't just about hospitals and roads. Meerut, Kumar says, has carved out a niche for itself. "Cricket bats from Meerut are legendary," he declares with pride, mentioning the renowned manufacturers like Sanspareils Greenlands (SG) and B. D. Mahajan and Sons Private Limited (BDM).

Business-wise, Meerut is home to sports equipment manufacturing units, particularly cricket gear. With renowned companies like SG, BDM, and Sareen Sports Industries (SS) headquartered in the city, Meerut supplies cricket bats to national and international players alike. "And the musical instruments," Kumar adds.

Education, too, had taken centre stage. Universities like Shobit and Subharti have sprung up, offering world-class education. Then there are prestigious government universities like CCS University and Sardar Vallabh Bhai Patel University. Plus, more than 50 engineering colleges have been established in the last 10 years, apart from prestigious professional colleges and the coaching industry for competitive exams like NEET and JEE, catering to the needs of the youth.

As an informed middle class increases in these cities, its tastes have changed, and that has led to a demand for newer urban amenities like malls. Aman Gupta, Director at the RPS Group, says malls like the Shopprix Mall and The Rave@Meerut are set to change the picture in terms of retail trade. "Such malls are not only designed as shopping centres but also as retail centres with multiplexes, food courts, and other recreational activities. Future projects in this sector will boost the city's attractiveness even more, particularly among the youth and families," he says.

Meerut has received a shot in the arm with projects like the Regional Rapid Transit System (RRTS), which will soon connect the city to Delhi, and the Meerut-Delhi Expressway, a 14-lane highway. There is also the upcoming Meerut Metro and the 594-km Ganga Expressway from Meerut to Prayagraj. These projects, coupled with the proposed logistics hub, are poised to transform the city into a regional powerhouse.

"As far as real estate investors are concerned, investment in Meerut brings together both affordability and room for growth," Gupta says. Properties positioned around the RRTS, junctions of the expressway and emerging commercial pockets have started gaining traction.

## Vapi

Vapi in Gujarat, too, is set to reap the benefits of a large infrastructure project. The Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail (MAHSR) corridor—India's first bullet train project that is expected to be completed by 2026—will run through Vapi station.